

GA and Shopify

As a thumb rule, remember that GA should be enabled on your Shopify account only once. Enabling it more than once could mean that the tracking and data provided from it can be inaccurate. So before you set out to enable GA, ensure that it hasn't already been enabled on your website. If you are absolutely sure that GA has not been enabled on your account and you already have a Google account in place, that you want you can use for tracking purposes, then you can skip right ahead to the step of installing Universal Analytics.

If you already have GA enabled on your Shopify store, then your *theme.liquid* file will have the following scripts contained within them -

- ga.js
- dc.js
- analytics.js

In case your file contains scripts, then retain them only if you are looking to upgrade from Classic Analytics to Universal Analytics, or if you have any other technical reason.

If you would like to check for any potential problems with your site's tracking scripts, install Google's Tag Assistant. If the Tag Assistant detects any issues, it will show an error message when you visit the site. For instance, you will see a message like the following -

Error: Multiple Google Analytics tags detected.

Error: Detected both ga.js and dc.js scripts which will make tracking ambiguous.

Shopify recommends that users opt for Universal Analytics, which is the latest version of GA. Although Shopify also supports Classic Analytics, you should use Universal Analytics unless you have specific requirements. Universal Analytics does everything that Classic Analytics can do, and more.

If you are currently running Classic Analytics, then the process to upgrade can be found in your Online Store under the 'preferences' on the admin dashboard. Here's how to do it -

- Open Shopify admin in a fresh browser window
- Shopify Admin>Online Store>Preferences
- Scroll down to the GA section, and select 'Upgrade to the latest version'

Enable Universal Analytics

To enable Universal Google Analytics:

- From the GA home page, click on 'Sign In'.